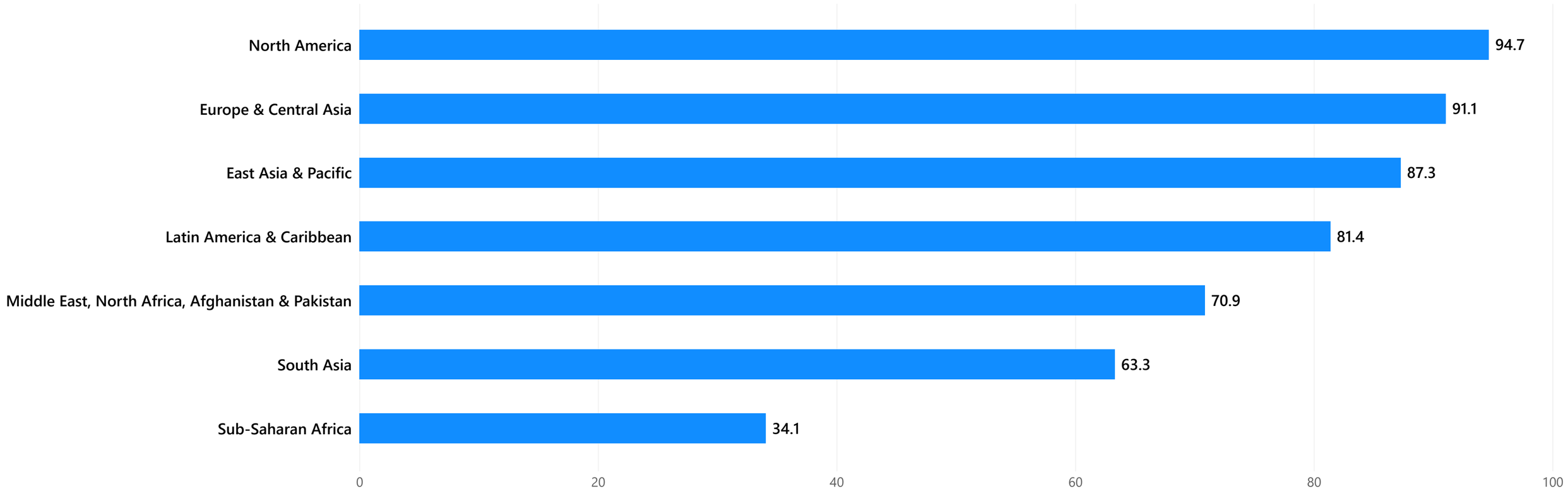
The digital divide at a glance

Who is online, how fast, and how wide the gap is between rich and poor countries.

People online, world (%)	Fixed broadband, world (Mbps)	High- vs low-income speed (×)	Fixed broadband, Netherlands (Mbps)	Speed data: quarter	Internet data: year
72.7	242.5	7.4	324.9	2026 Q3	2024

People online by region, latest reliable year (%)

Internet Users % (latest reliable) by Group



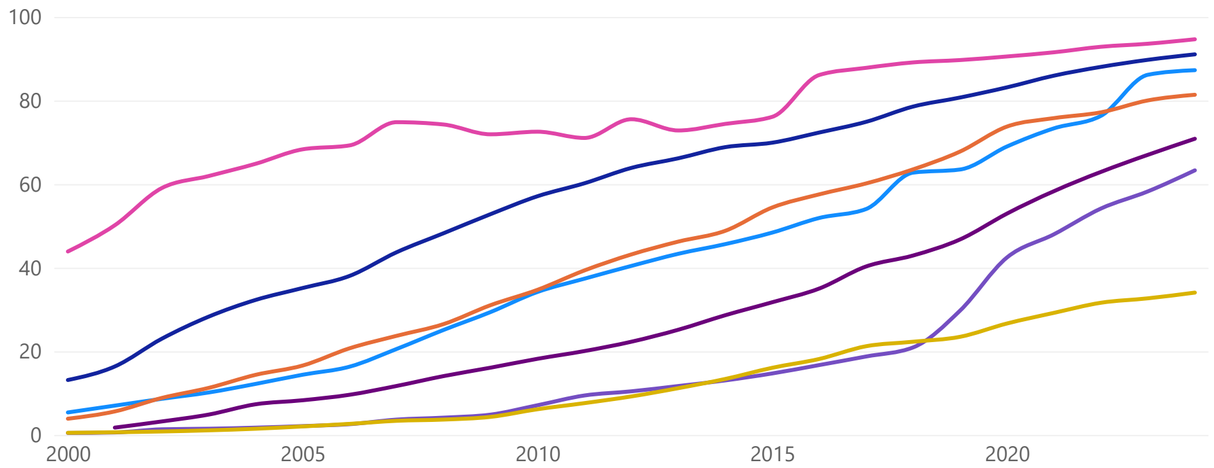
Sources: World Bank WDI (CC BY 4.0); Ookla Open Data speed tests (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0). Speeds are test-weighted means; group values count only years whose reporting countries cover at least 90% of the population. See Methods.

Who is online, and how fast?

Internet use by region over time, and how speed relates to income.

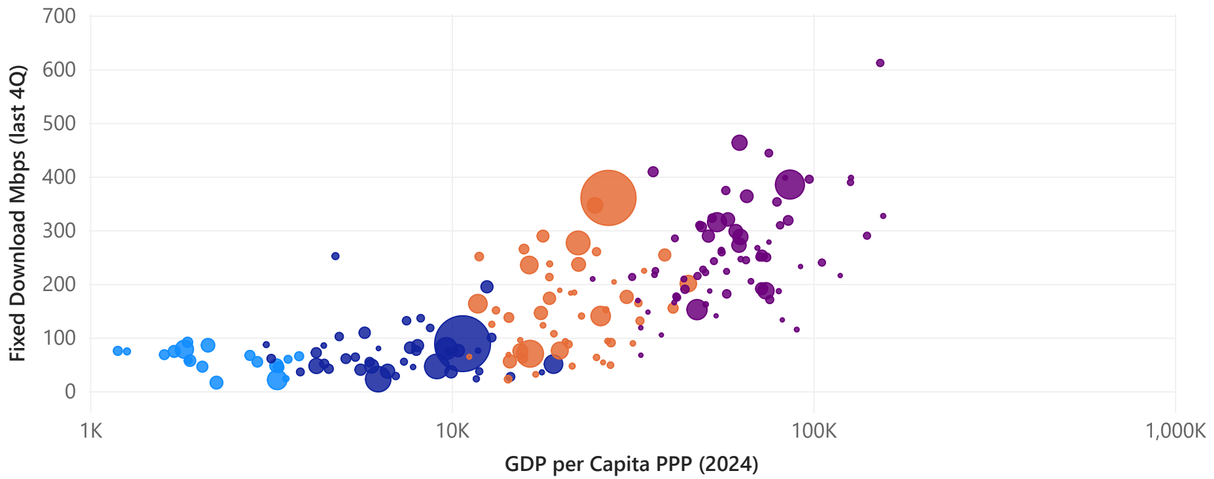
People online by region (%)

Group Value by Year and Group



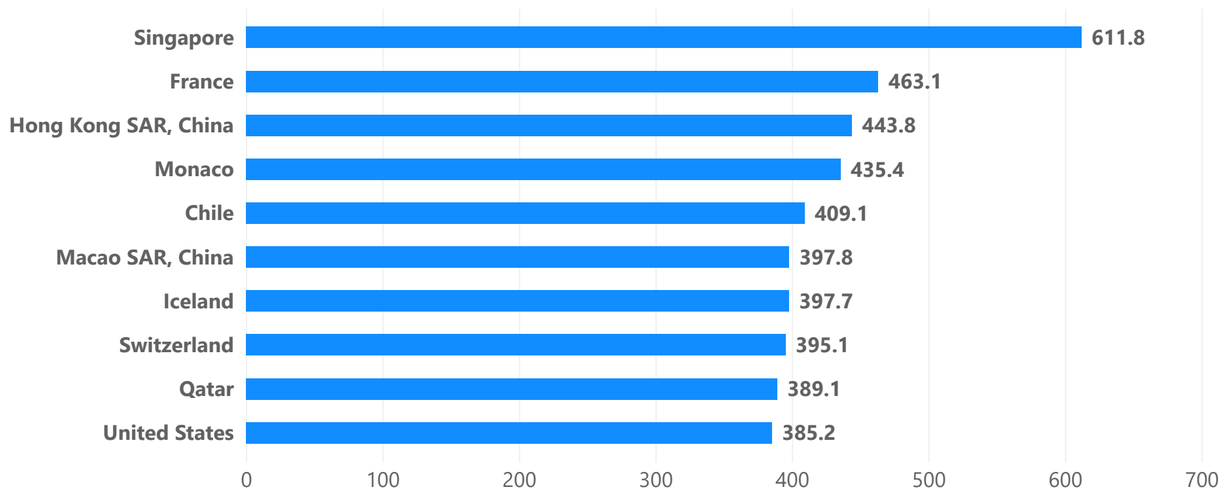
Richer countries have faster broadband

GDP per Capita PPP (2024), Fixed Download Mbps (last 4Q) and Population (2024) by Country and Income group (FY27)



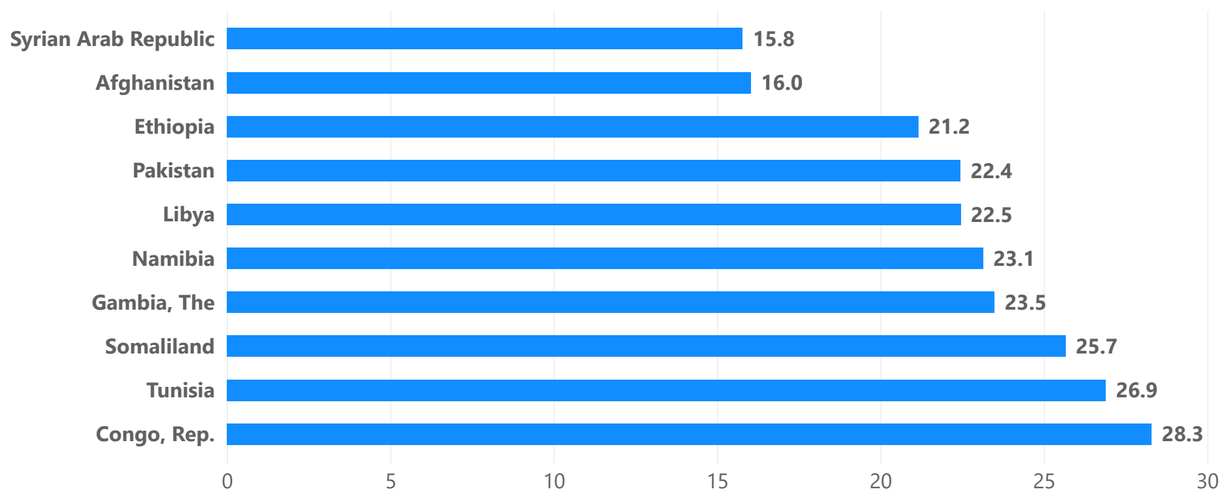
Fastest fixed broadband (Mbps, last 4 quarters)

Fixed Download Mbps (last 4Q) by Country



Slowest fixed broadband (Mbps, last 4 quarters)

Fixed Download Mbps (last 4Q) by Country



Is the income gap closing?

Internet use and broadband speed by World Bank income group.

High- vs low-income fixed speed, latest quarter (×)

7.4

Classification

Income group (classification at the time)

Income group (FY27 classification)

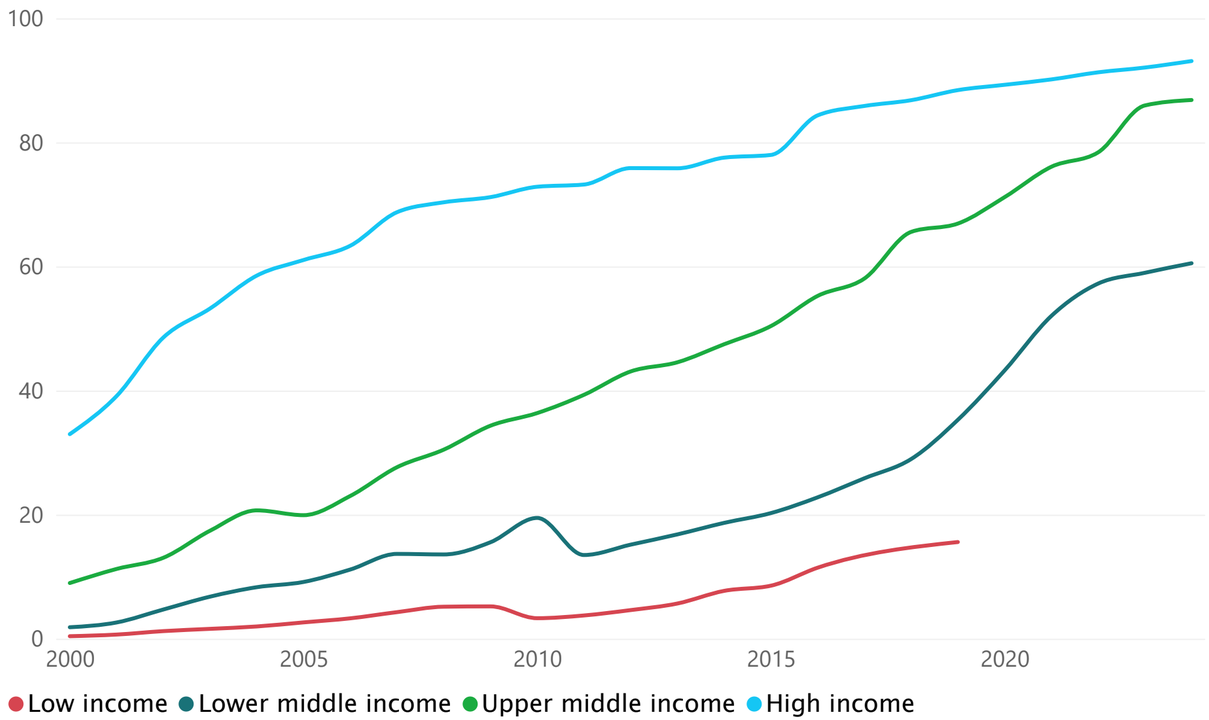
Connection

Fixed broadband

Mobile

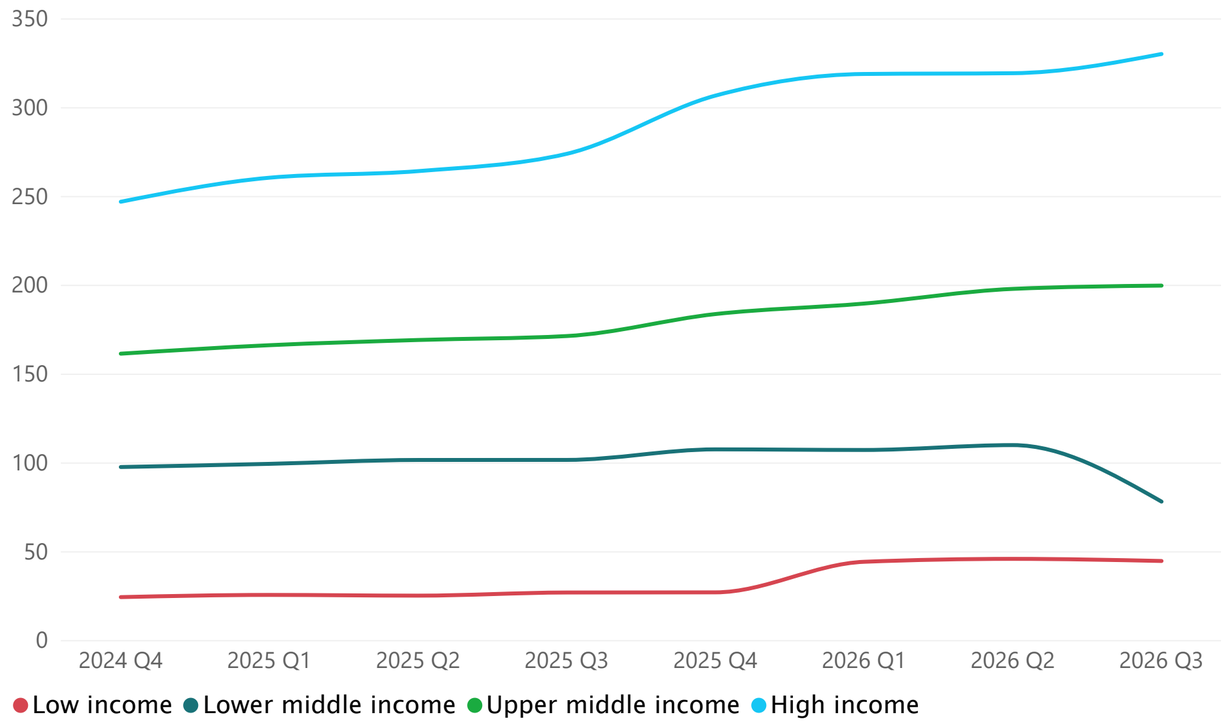
People online by income group (%)

Shown when reporting countries cover at least 90% of the group's population



Download speed by income group (Mbps)

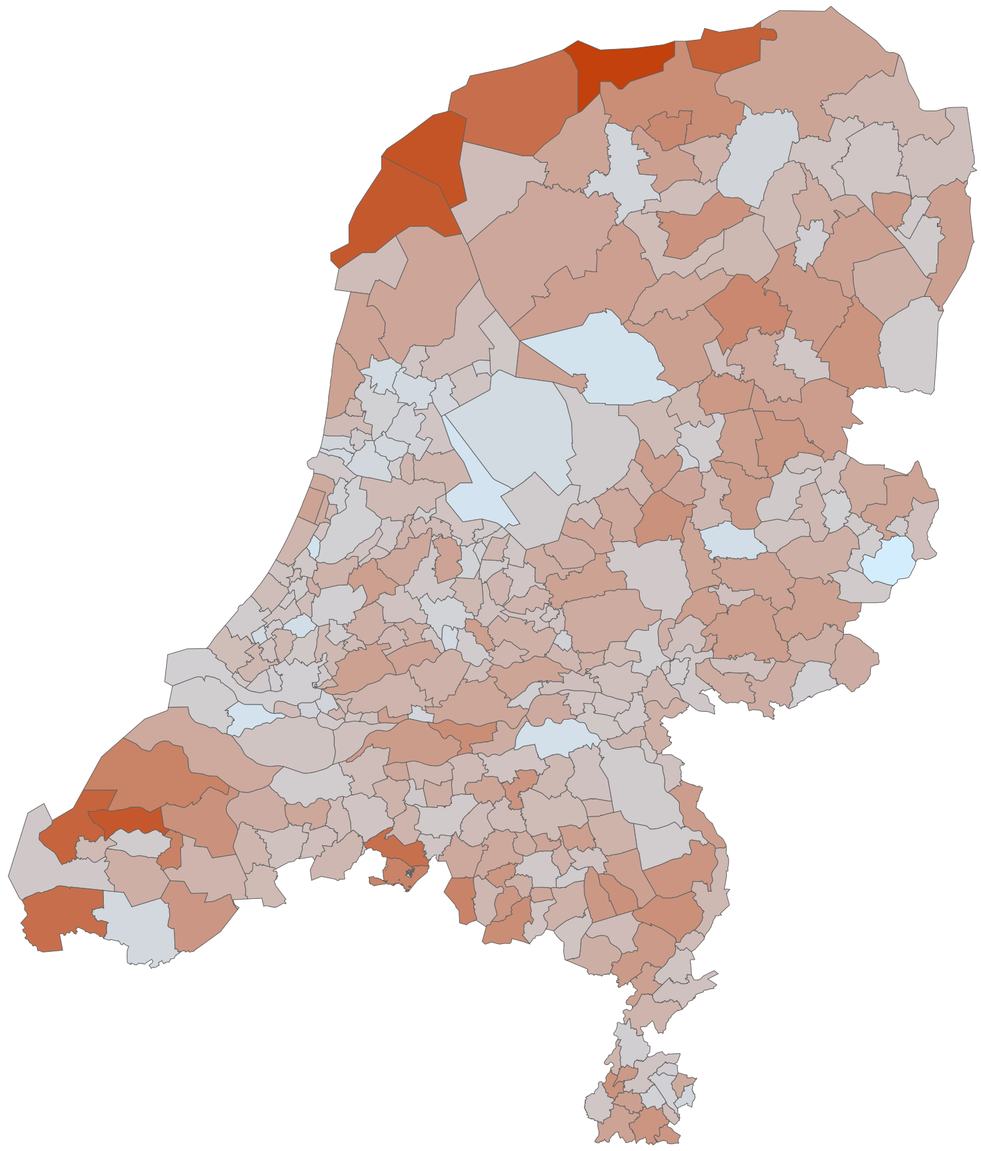
Weighted by number of tests, last 8 quarters; fixed or mobile per Connection



Classification matters: in 2005, 61.0% of people in countries that were high-income at the time were online, but only 52.7% in today's high-income countries, because several of them joined the group later. The same effect explains the drop in lower-middle-income speed in 2026 Q3 under "classification at the time": the FY27 list took effect in July 2026 and moved some countries between groups. Low-income data stop in 2019 (in 2016 under the FY27 list): since 2020, countries with about a fifth of the group's population (Sudan, Yemen, North Korea, Syria, South Sudan, Eritrea) have not reported, so the group value is hidden (coverage below 90%).

Fixed broadband download speed by municipality

NL Latest quarter fixed Mbps (2026 Q3) by Municipality



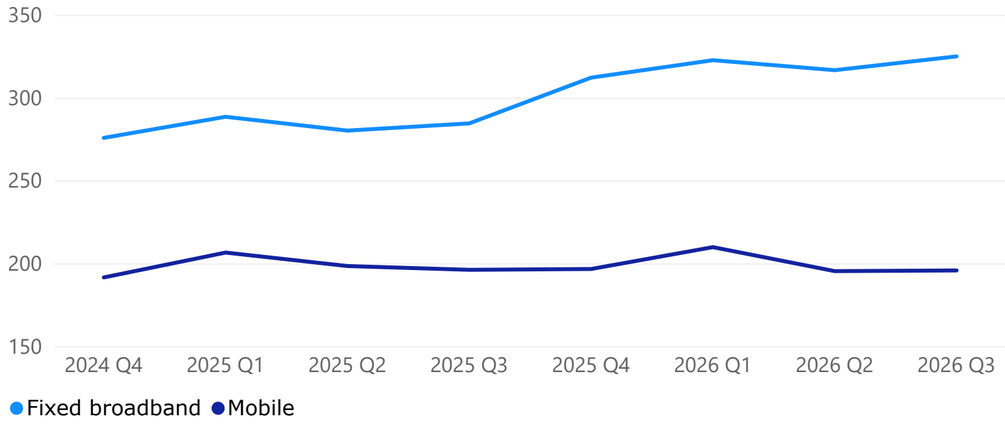
Province

All

Municipality	Province	NL Fixed Mbps (latest quarter)
Ameland	Fryslân	116.8
Vlieland	Fryslân	147.4
Noord-Beveland	Zeeland	154.0
Texel	Noord-Holland	156.4
Schiermonnikoog	Fryslân	167.2
Veere	Zeeland	173.9
Sluis	Zeeland	192.0
Terschelling	Fryslân	192.1
Alphen-Chaam	Noord-Brabant	193.0
Kapelle	Zeeland	222.9
Schouwen-Duiveland	Zeeland	224.1
Baarle-Nassau	Noord-Brabant	224.1
Reusel-De Mierden	Noord-Brabant	224.5
Westerveld	Drenthe	232.4
Dantumadiel	Fryslân	233.7

Download speed in the Netherlands by quarter

Fixed broadband vs mobile, test-weighted mean per quarter, Mbps



How the numbers are made

Sources, calculation rules and known limitations.

Data sources

• Internet use, GDP per capita (PPP) and population: World Bank, World Development Indicators (CC BY 4.0). Internet indicators originate from ITU.
• Income groups: World Bank historical classification (OGHIST), shown either as the group a country was in that year or as today's FY27 list.
• Broadband speed: Ookla Open Data speed tests (© Ookla, CC BY-NC-SA 4.0), 8 quarters from 2024 Q4 to 2026 Q3, fixed and mobile.
• Country boundaries: Made with Natural Earth (public domain). Dutch municipalities: © Kadaster via PDOK (CC BY 4.0).
Pipeline: Python ingestion → Databricks (PySpark, Delta) → dbt Gold layer → Power BI. Orchestrated with Airflow, infrastructure in Terraform.

How values are calculated

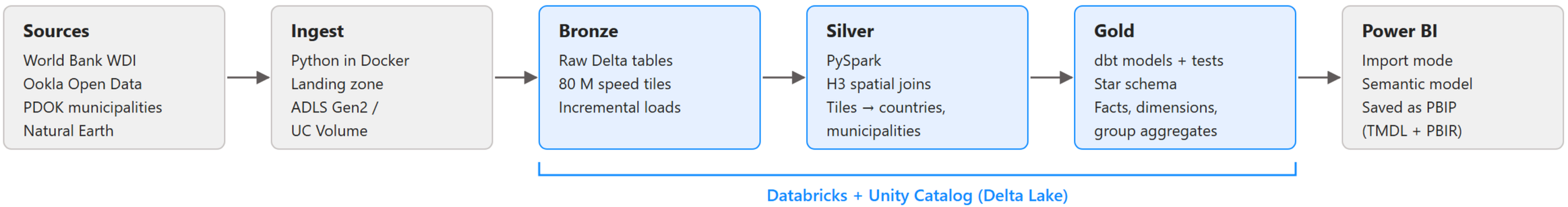
• Speeds are test-weighted averages: the sum of (tile average × tests) divided by the sum of tests, never an average of averages.
• Speed tiles are assigned to countries and municipalities with an H3 spatial index.
• Group and world values are weighted by tests (speed) or population (internet use).
• A group value is shown only when reporting countries cover at least 90% of the group's population; otherwise it is hidden.
• Low sample: a country quarter with fewer than 1,000 tests or a municipality quarter with fewer than 100 is flagged. Last-4-quarter speeds need at least 4,000 tests.
• "Latest" values pick the latest quarter or latest reliable year automatically.

Limitations

• Ookla tests are run by users who choose to test, so they describe tested connections, not all households.
• Speed data cover only 8 quarters; long-run speed trends are not available.
• Natural Earth boundaries are de facto. Tests can be attributed to an area whose economic data describe a different population (for example West Bank and Gaza).
• Some units (such as Somaliland) have speed data but no World Bank indicators.
• Changes in income classification move countries between groups and can shift group values without any real change.
• Recent internet-use values are incomplete: 2025 is hidden because coverage is below 90%.

Pipeline

from public sources to this report



Orchestration
Airflow 3: ingest task image + Databricks jobs

Infrastructure
Terraform: Azure resources, budget alert

CI
GitHub Actions: ruff, pytest, dbt parse,
DAG test, Terraform validate, gitleaks